



Facebook's new privacy controls

Facebook announces new privacy controls in compliance with EU's GDPR for its 2.2 million users in Europe. <https://digit.in/fbeuprivacy>



Amazon US goes international

Amazon has launched international shopping from its US store, 45 million items available for shipping overseas. <https://digit.in/amazonus>

Fractal Design Define R6

Silent and sturdy

The Define R6 Black Tempered Glass edition stands on top of Fractal Design's new India series. Will the case be also able to deliver acceptable cooling for long with silent performance?

Exteriors

The Define R6 is available in both a tempered glass edition and an acrylic side-window panel variant. We reviewed the black tempered glass edition. The front panel has a hinged-design to swivel open. Despite the tempered glass the cabinet offers you a lot of mobility. Additionally, there are other modules such as HDMI pass-throughs or extra USB 3.0 ports that can be installed. While the side panels are implemented with tempered glass, the edges, however, are made of steel with studs and thumbscrews keeping it in place.

The button mechanism on the Define R6 is amazing. Pushing the button on the top detaches the cover and you can take it off easily. The cover contains a dust filter and the same high-density dampening material. There's incredible support for both fans and radiators on the top panel.

The Define R6 also consists of two expansion slots for vertical GPUs. However, there's no riser cable or adapter mount included. All of the expansion slots are attached using thumbscrews. On the bottom, you'll find a single dust filter takes the entire bottom area of the case including the two fan mounts on the bottom of the case and the PSU.

The Interior

Slots that support both HDDs and SSDs are present in R6. Two drives can also be installed below the PSU



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BUILD QUALITY.....	90
FEATURES.....	85
VALUE.....	63

shroud level. Fractal Design provides six metal trays and they can be installed anywhere out of the 11 mounting holes. The extra drives don't

really hinder the airflow from the front intake fans.

There are two SSD trays behind the motherboard plate. These trays can also be inserted over the PSU shroud. You get a max PSU length of 160mm with two fans which increases to 300mm with a single fan.

There's massive support for radiators in the case, especially on the top panel. The Nexus+ Smart Hub allows you to use six three-pin case fans and three four-pin PWM devices or fans.

Assembling our test rig in the Define R6 was a simple process. By just spending a few extra minutes, we were able to achieve a clean setup. There was absolutely no problem in installing the components and the entire building experience was pleasing.

Thermal performance

Surprisingly, being a silent case by classification, the Define R6 does a well in keeping the components cool without any temperature anomalies.

Price
₹13,083

After testing the case with the installed fans, we found that adding more exhaust fans on the top didn't really matter much.

Acoustic performance

Touted as a silent case, the Define R6 does manage to dampen the noise from the fans to an extent. But even though the front, top and other side panel have a dampening layer, the tempered glass side panel isn't able to dampen the noise. Overall, with the other panels attached, you can expect a comparatively silent case than cases without such a layer.

Our Verdict

The Fractal Design Define R6 tries to find a middle-ground between silent performance and cooling performance.

Apart from an above average cooling performance, the Define R6 has an incredible build quality and delivers all the expected features at this price range. However, they miss out on including a USB Type-C connector on the front IO ports. With an amazing potential for future upgrades inside, this could definitely be a case you can consider for your high-end rig.

—Abhijit Dey

SPECIFICATIONS

MOTHERBOARD FORM FACTOR: Mini-ITX, Micro-ATX, ATX | POWER SUPPLY STANDARD: ATX standard (max. length of 300mm) | I/O PORTS: 2x USB 3.0, 2x USB 3.0, 1x microphone, 1x headphone | DRIVE BAYS: 6 x 3.5-inch HDD, 2 x 2.5-inch SSD | COOLING SUPPORT: 3 x 120mm (front), 2 x 140mm (front), 3 x 120/140mm (top), 1 x 120/140mm (rear), 2 x 120/140mm (bottom) | RADIATOR SUPPORT: Up to 280/360mm (front), up to 360/420mm (top), up to 120mm (rear), up to 240/280mm (bottom) | CLEARANCES: CPU cooler - 185mm, Graphics card - 440mm | DIMENSIONS (H X W X D): 465mm x 234mm x 536mm

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